Chapter 5 – Australian History

The Aborigines of Australia are considered to be the world's oldest continuous people. It is generally accepted that their ancestors arrived in Australia a minimum of 50,000 years ago via boat. When the Europeans arrived, there was an estimated 1,000,000 Aborigines living throughout the country as hunter-gatherers. There were 500 tribes or nations present across the country and they spoke around 700 languages at the time. They are known for travelling large distances for trading and ceremonial purposes. The landscape during this time included lush rainforests, snowy mountains and deserts.

The Aborigine nations believed in the Dreaming, which is also known as Tjukurrpa. Ancient Aborigine mythology mentions that all life and land was created by the ancestor spirits who also connected everything in the past and present through signs. The Dreaming myths of the spirit ancestors were retold through different mediums such as stories, art, dancing and singing.